

THE GIFTS OF THE SPIRIT

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DIVERS KINDS OF TONGUES

INTRO: The gift we are about to study is possibly the most difficult of all the gifts to teach, simply because it is widely practiced by people who have a limited understanding of its proper Biblical operation. You would be hard pressed to find a dozen people in a Pentecostal or charismatic church who would admit to not knowing the reason for, and the proper operation of, this gift. A closer study of the aptitude of the general public within the same churches would no doubt reveal a huge deficiency in the Biblical guidelines that govern the proper operation of this gift. As a result of assumed knowledge this gift is probably the most often abused of all the gifts.

Going all the way back to the first family of the human race it is apparent in Scripture that **God gave Adam a mother tongue or universal language with which he communicated with his wife and family. Every person born in the line of Adam spoke this universal language.** Because of the sin of pride and arrogance God

confounded the languages at the tower of Babel. With the confounding of the languages the population of the earth began to be segregated into little population pockets of language friendly people. This language barrier redefined the geographical locality of the human race causing them to settle their families in previously unexplored lands.

The confounding of the languages literally sent people who would not have gone by any other means, to the ends of the earth. Isn't it ironic that [divers kinds of tongues were first imparted to heathens who when they received their language, immediately went into all the world.](#)

In the New Testament Jesus prophesied the arrival of the Holy Spirit and stated that when they received Him they would have power to become witnesses to the entire world. Acts 1:8 (NKJV) ***“But you shall receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you; and you shall be witnesses to Me in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the end of the earth.”***

In this study we are going to explore:

- The initial physical evidence of Holy Spirit baptism

- Unknown tongues
- Divers kinds of tongues
- The gift of tongues

INITIAL PHYSICAL EVIDENCE

I want to begin by talking about the Initial Physical evidence of Holy Spirit baptism. The gift of the Holy Spirit is available to every born again believer. The Holy Spirit is not given in response to a threshold of personal holiness achieved by the believer.

The Holy Spirit is given that the believer may have extra power, along with a host of other reasons; one of which is that the believer could communicate with the Father in the Father's language.

The gift of the Holy Spirit is subsequent to salvation. [Many believe they receive the Holy Spirit when they receive Christ](#). This is in part true; when we were converted the Holy Spirit came along side us. He actually seals us against the day of redemption. Ephesians 1:13-14 (NKJV) ***"In Him you also trusted, after you heard the word of truth, the gospel of your salvation; in whom also, having believed, you were sealed with the Holy Spirit of promise,***14

who is the guarantee of our inheritance until the redemption of the purchased possession, to the praise of His glory." John 14:15-17

(NKJV) "If you love Me, keep My commandments.16 "And I will pray the Father, and He will give you another Helper, that He may abide with you forever—17 "the Spirit of truth, whom the world cannot receive, because it neither sees Him nor knows Him; but you know Him, for He dwells with you and will be in you."

Once we are sealed with the Holy Spirit of promise we are only a step away from entering into the [gateway](#) of God's giftedness. There is strong Scriptural evidence of the Holy Spirit being a second definite work of grace apart from, and subsequent to, conversion. Acts 19:1-7 (NKJV) *"And it happened, while Apollos was at Corinth, that Paul, having passed through the upper regions, came to Ephesus. And finding some disciples2 he said to them, "Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you believed?" So they said to him, "We have not so much as heard whether there is a Holy Spirit."3 And he said to them, "Into what then were you baptized?" So they said, "Into John's baptism."4 Then Paul said, "John indeed baptized with a baptism of repentance, saying*

to the people that they should believe on Him who would come after him, that is, on Christ Jesus.”⁵ When they heard this, they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.⁶ And when Paul had laid hands on them, the Holy Spirit came upon them, and they spoke with tongues and prophesied.⁷ Now the men were about twelve in all. ”

The initial outpouring in the upper room featured all 120 present speaking in tongues.

Acts 2:1-4 (NKJV) *”When the Day of Pentecost had fully come, they were all with one accord in one place.² And suddenly there came a sound from heaven, as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled the whole house where they were sitting.³ Then there appeared to them divided tongues, as of fire, and one sat upon each of them.⁴ And they were all filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance.”*

If I rightly divide Acts two, the first physical evidence that these believers had received the promise of the Father was the fact they spoke in tongues.

Why do you suppose the Father chose to use tongues as the initial physical sign of the

baptism in the Holy Spirit? James 3:3-9

(NKJV) *"Indeed, we put bits in horses'*

mouths that they may obey us, and we turn

*their whole body.*⁴ *Look also at ships:*

although they are so large and are driven by

fierce winds, they are turned by a very small

*rudder wherever the pilot desires.*⁵ *Even so the*

tongue is a little member and boasts great

things. See how great a forest a little fire

*kindles!*⁶ *And the tongue is a fire, a world of*

iniquity. The tongue is so set among our

members that it defiles the whole body, and

sets on fire the course of nature; and it is set

*on fire by hell.*⁷ *For every kind of beast and*

bird, of reptile and creature of the sea, is

*tamed and has been tamed by mankind.*⁸ *But*

no man can tame the tongue. It is an unruly

*evil, full of deadly poison.*⁹ *With it we bless*

our God and Father, and with it we curse men,

who have been made in the similitude of

God." Considering this Scripture, it appears the

tongue is the most difficult member of the body

to bring under subjection to the will of man and

of God. Thus, if a man can surrender his tongue

to God he has without question surrendered

completely. When a person surrenders

completely to God they are baptized in the Holy

Spirit and speak in tongues.

Is there sufficient Scriptural evidence of tongues being the first physical indication of a believer being baptized in the Holy Spirit? [Take a walk with me through the book of Acts:](#)
(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

1. [Acts 2:1-4](#) The 120 in the Upper Room spoke in tongues. (NKJV) ***“When the Day of Pentecost had fully come, they were all with one accord in one place.² And suddenly there came a sound from heaven, as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled the whole house where they were sitting.³ Then there appeared to them divided tongues, as of fire, and one sat upon each of them.⁴ And they were all filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance.”***
2. [Acts 8:15-18](#) The Bible does not say the Samaritans spoke in tongues but Simon witnessed some kind of outward manifestation and offered to buy the ability to impart the Holy Spirit. (NKJV) ***“Now when the apostles who were at Jerusalem heard that Samaria had received the word of God, they sent Peter and John to them,¹⁵ who,***

*when they had come down, prayed for them that they might receive the Holy Spirit.*¹⁶ *For as yet He had fallen upon none of them. They had only been baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.*¹⁷ *Then they laid hands on them, and they received the Holy Spirit.*¹⁸ *And when Simon saw that through the laying on of the apostles' hands the Holy Spirit was given, he offered them money,*¹⁹ *saying, "Give me this power also, that anyone on whom I lay hands may receive the Holy Spirit."*

3. [Acts 9:17-18](#) Saul, who would later become Paul receives the Holy Spirit. (NKJV) *"And Ananias went his way and entered the house; and laying his hands on him he said, "Brother Saul, the Lord Jesus, who appeared to you on the road as you came, has sent me that you may receive your sight and be filled with the Holy Spirit."*¹⁸ *Immediately there fell from his eyes something like scales, and he received his sight at once; and he arose and was baptized."*

4. [Acts 10:44-46](#) The house of Cornelius received the Holy Spirit and spoke in

tongues. (NKJV) ***“While Peter was still speaking these words, the Holy Spirit fell upon all those who heard the word.”***⁴⁵ ***And those of the circumcision who believed were astonished, as many as came with Peter, because the gift of the Holy Spirit had been poured out on the Gentiles also.***⁴⁶ ***For they heard them speak with tongues and magnify God...***”

5. [Acts 19:1-7](#) The believers at Ephesus received the Holy Spirit and spoke in tongues. (NKJV) ***“And it happened, while Apollos was at Corinth, that Paul, having passed through the upper regions, came to Ephesus. And finding some disciples² he said to them, “Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you believed?” So they said to him, “We have not so much as heard whether there is a Holy Spirit.”***³ ***And he said to them, “Into what then were you baptized?” So they said, “Into John’s baptism.”***⁴ ***Then Paul said, “John indeed baptized with a baptism of repentance, saying to the people that they should believe on Him who would come after him, that is, on***

Christ Jesus.”5 When they heard this, they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.6 And when Paul had laid hands on them, the Holy Spirit came upon them, and they spoke with tongues and prophesied.7 Now the men were about twelve in all.”

UNKNOWN TONGUE

Having established that tongues is in fact the first physical evidence that a person has actually received the infilling of the Holy Spirit, we must ask, [what kind of tongue does the believer receive in that initial experience?](#)

Generally speaking I believe the individual receives an unknown tongue which in turn establishes a prayer language for the believer to use, to build himself up in his most holy faith. Jude 20-21 (NKJV) "***But you, beloved, building yourselves up on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Spirit,21 keep yourselves in the love of God, looking for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ unto eternal life.***"

This initial outpouring of the Holy Spirit in the upper room featured the 120 actually speaking in divers kinds of tongues. Acts 2:1-8 (KJV) "***And when the day of Pentecost was fully***

come, they were all with one accord in one place. 2 And suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled all the house where they were sitting. 3 And there appeared unto them cloven tongues like as of fire, and it sat upon each of them. 4 And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance. 5 "And there were dwelling at Jerusalem Jews, devout men, out of every nation under heaven. 6 Now when this was noised abroad, the multitude came together, and were confounded, because that every man heard them speak in his own language. 7 And they were all amazed and marvelled, saying one to another, Behold, are not all these which speak Galilaeans? 8 And how hear we every man in our own tongue, wherein we were born?"

This is the only place I can find in the Bible that new believers speak in anything other than an unknown tongue. Every occasion subsequent to this initial outpouring in the upper room, where the Scripture records that an individual received the infilling of the Holy Spirit, there is no reference made to anyone present understanding the language they were speaking.

After careful study I believe there may have been three separate things happening in Acts two: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- These people were filled with the Holy Spirit in the upper room - I can't say for sure, but I believe they initially spoke in an unknown tongue -Acts 2:4 (NKJV)
"And they were all filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance."
- They vacated the upper room and attracted the public - Acts 2:6 (KJV)
"Now when this was noised abroad, the multitude came together..."
- It is in this venue that the Scripture makes us aware the general public heard them speak in various languages - The Gift of tongues employing the use of divers kinds of tongues is obviously in operation here - Acts 2:6-8 (KJV) *"Now when this was noised abroad, the multitude came together, and were confounded, because that every man heard them speak in his own language. 7 And they were all amazed and marvelled, saying one to another, Behold, are not all these which speak Galilaeans? 8 And how hear we*

every man in our own tongue, wherein we were born?"

The unknown tongue is exactly as it is stated in the Bible: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- It is unknown to the believer
- It is unknown to those present
- It is unknown to all other nationalities
- It is unknown to the enemy

DIVERS KINDS OF TONGUES

Very simply put, divers kinds of tongues, is the use of the languages of the world through an individual who has never studied or committed to memory that particular language.

As you know, learning a second language can be very difficult and requires a commitment of time and resources. Some of you are fluent in multiple languages and you can appreciate the effort and time that goes into being bilingual

If I were to tell those of you who are bilingual that in the natural I can fluently speak English, Spanish, and French without ever having

studied the languages, you would laugh me out of the room. It would literally be impossible to do such a thing in the natural.

Remember, that which is impossible in the natural is oftentimes made possible in the spiritual.

The languages of the world are employed through the knowledge of the Holy Spirit during the implementation of the gift of divers kinds of tongues.

The Scripture makes reference to Tongues being a sign to the unbeliever. 1 Corinthians 14:22 (NKJV) ***"Therefore tongues are for a sign, not to those who believe but to unbelievers; but prophesying is not for unbelievers but for those who believe."*** How is this possible?

- When a believer speaks in tongues it is a sign to the unbeliever that the individual has been baptized in the Holy Spirit
- When a believer speaks in a language they have never learned, which happens to be the native language of the unbeliever, can have a very effective impact on the unbeliever

- When a believer speaks in a language they have never learned, followed by the gift of interpretation of tongues, this often speaks directly to the unbeliever concerning particular events in their life

THE GIFT OF TONGUES

The gift of tongues is a gift apart from the [infilling of the Holy Spirit](#). While there is strong Scriptural authentication that when a person is baptized in the Holy Spirit they speak in tongues, the gift of tongues is a separate gift of the Spirit, God has offered to all believers.

While speaking in an unknown tongue is given to edify the individual believer [the gift of tongues is given for the reason of edifying the church](#). 1 Corinthians 14:1-4 (KJV) *"Follow after charity, and desire spiritual gifts, but rather that ye may prophesy. 2 For he that speaketh in an unknown tongue speaketh not unto men, but unto God: for no man understandeth him; howbeit in the spirit he speaketh mysteries. 3 But he that prophesieth speaketh unto men to edification, and exhortation, and comfort. 4 He that speaketh in an unknown tongue edifieth himself; but he that prophesieth edifieth the church"* In this Scripture we see the distinction between an

unknown tongue and divers kinds of tongues being manifested as the gift of tongues. The use of divers kinds of tongues is employed in the operation of the gift of tongues because it is to be followed by the gift of interpretation of tongues. If one wishes to be used in this wonderful gift the following procedures should be closely followed: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Pray to be used in this important gift
- Pray for special sensitivity to the Holy Spirit to know when to speak and when to be silent
- Remember, God will never interrupt one anointing with another anointing
- Having given a message in tongues one should silently await the interpretation
- Having given a message in tongues and there is no interpretation one should pray to receive the interpretation
- Having given a message in tongues and there is no interpretation one should not repeat the message

PRACTICAL APPLICATION:

Remember the following facts concerning tongues: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Tongues are the initial physical evidence of Holy Spirit baptism
- Speaking in an unknown tongue is essential to the spiritual development of the believer - 1 Corinthians 14:4 (NKJV) ***"He who speaks in a tongue edifies himself, but he who prophesies edifies the church."*** Jude 20 (NKJV) ***"But you, beloved, building yourselves up on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Spirit,"***
- The unknown tongue should be frequently employed in ones private prayer time - 1 Corinthians 14:18 (NKJV) ***"I thank my God, I speak with tongues more than ye all:"*** During my walk with God as a Spirit filled believer there have been several times that the gift of tongues operated in my private prayer time followed by the interpretation - Each time this occurred I was given Divine direction concerning specific situations
- The gift of tongues should be employed in the corporate church
- When the gift of tongues is employed in the corporate church the number of

occurrences is limited by Scriptural
[mandate](#) 1Corinthians 14:27-29 (NKJV)

*"If anyone speaks in a tongue, let there
be two or at the most three, each in turn,
and let one interpret.28 But if there is no
interpreter, let him keep silent in church,
and let him speak to himself and to
God.29 Let two or three prophets speak,
and let the others judge."*